

SEX AND THE CITY

LUSTY LUDHIANA The sex survey in 2006 saw 48 per cent from Ludhiana admitting to having had sex in front of the mirror while 63 per cent had paid for sex. In 2008, 33 per cent Ludhiana men had slept with a prostitute. This year, the city, however, tops the chart when it comes to fantasising about having sex with strangers (54 per cent), having anal sex (51 per cent) and sex on rooftops (42 per cent).

CANDID CAMERA In Delhi, 67 per cent women have made an MMS of themselves while having sex. In 2008, Bangalore took the lead with 25 per cent women admitting to it.

GAY PRIDE Fifteen per cent men in Jaipur have had sex with a male. In 2008, Hyderabad emerged as the country's gay capital, where 61 per cent men approved of homosexuality. In 2006, 58 per cent in Ahmedabad reported to having had a homosexual experience.

UNDER COVER In Mumbai, 44 per cent women have secretly watched someone having sex.

compiled by Priya Verma

BANDEEP SINGH/www.indiatodayimages.com



married men and women fantasise about making MMS and trying sex toys than those who are single. And therein lies the survey's greatest triumph. Sex within marriage may not be the start of a great dialogue between the sexes, but at least it has put them on the road to acknowledging physical pleasure. As ads for contraceptive pills and condoms aired during primetime suggest, sex doesn't come with a schedule. It often just "happens". Sex may no longer be what Rita Banerji in *Sex and Power* called the "pariah dog that roams the streets, the pagan outside the sacred walls". No doubt

much of it is because there is so much more sex in the public domain now, on television, in newspaper supplements and in the movies. Is it finally emboldening men and women to rid themselves of Victorian prudery?

At the normative level, the respondents seem to realise that sexual fantasies help understand our sexual nature better. How we dream about sex is often a better pointer to our intimate natures. Typically though most urban Indians don't believe that it is acceptable for older people to have sexual fantasies. They don't also seem to believe in the primacy of sex in the lives. Other things seem to give them more satisfaction—whether it is their social life, their

NOT SO DESPERATE

Sex is everywhere but on the minds of urban Indians. Most women (20 per cent) think about sex less than once a week compared to 21 per cent men who think of it daily.



Figures don't add up to 100 because of multiple choices. All figures in per cent.

Almost 18 per cent men in Ludhiana and 10 per cent women in Jaipur think of sex more than five times a day. On the other hand, 19 per cent respondents from Kolkata and 16 per cent from Jaipur claim to have never thought of sex.

60 PER CENT IN KOLKATA DON'T APPROVE OF OLDER PEOPLE HAVING SEXUAL FANTASIES WHILE 55 PER CENT IN MUMBAI HAVE NO OBJECTION TO IT.

families or their finances. They don't even think about it that often. Only 21 per cent of the men think about sex daily, compared to 17 per cent women. More than 50 per cent of the men and women do not think about sex even once a day.

It doesn't stop them from being satisfied. Both men (79 per cent) and women (71 per cent) seem to be quite confident of their prowess in the bedroom, rating themselves highly when it comes to pleasing their partners by trying out their sexual desires. This concern for the partner's pleasure, according to sociologist Patricia Uberoi, is a way to introduce romance and sex into mostly arranged marriages, where the couple meet as strangers. "The drive of fantasy is really to make conjugal relationships sexually fulfilling," she says. Play is always the first step towards pleasure.

with Chitra Subramanyam and Gunjeet Sra

Have a query or a concern? Resolve it in a **LIVE CHAT** with our expert from 1 p.m. to 3 p.m., December 2.
www.indiatoday.in/sexsurvey09

